

Saskatoon surgery prof likens his ouster from roles to Nazis, Soviet Union

Dr. Francis Christian has been removed from key roles with the Saskatchewan Health Authority and the University of Saskatchewan.

Author of the article:

Phil Tank • Saskatoon StarPhoenix

Publishing date:

Jun 24, 2021 • 1 day ago • 3 minute read • [Join the conversation](#)

<https://thestarphoenix.com/news/local-news/saskatoon-surgery-prof-likens-his-ouster-from-roles-to-nazis-soviet-union>



Dr. Francis Christian speaks at a news conference outside Walter Murray Collegiate for a group called Concerned Parents Saskatchewan to address their issues with students being vaccinated in Saskatoon, Thursday, June, 17, 2021. Kayle Neis/[^]Saskatoon StarPhoenix PHOTO BY KAYLE NEIS /Saskatoon StarPhoenix

Article content

A controversial Saskatoon surgery professor compared his removal from key positions for questioning the COVID-19 pandemic to the muzzling of academics in brutal totalitarian regimes.

Dr. Francis Christian was fired from his position with the Saskatchewan Health Authority and suspended from his academic roles with the University of Saskatchewan while his behaviour is investigated.

Sask. premier doubles down on no incentives for vaccinations

A 22-minute audio recording was posted online of a Wednesday meeting between Christian, SHA chief medical officer Dr. Susan Shaw, U of S College of Medicine dean Dr. Preston Smith and Dr. Brian Ulmer, acting provincial head of the department of surgery for the SHA and U of S.

Christian is informed in the meeting that concern has been raised about his central role in a demonstration in front of a Saskatoon high school last week to try to discourage teens from getting the COVID-19 vaccine.

“You’ve basically read indictments against me,” Christian says during the meeting. “These are the sort of panels that were set up in the Soviet Union and Nazi Germany against academics.

Advertisement

STORY CONTINUES BELOW

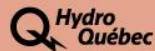
THE **RELAUNCH** REQUIRES EVERYONE'S **commitment**

Proud Pillar Sponsors:



Bell

CGI



RioTinto



Article content

“These are the type of panels, anyway. I’m not saying that you’re Nazis or Soviets, but it’s really disturbing, isn’t it?”

Christian has been suspended from his role as the director of quality improvement and patient safety in the department of surgery. His contract with the SHA for the same role has been terminated and will expire on Sept. 21.

Christian, a clinical professor of surgery, is told during the meeting that he will have an opportunity to appeal the suspension at the university and a letter has been sent to him with details.

Lawyer Jay Cameron of a Calgary-based legal advocacy group, the Justice Centre for Constitutional Freedoms, said in an interview that the centre is representing Christian.

Cameron confirmed Christian recorded the Wednesday meeting. Cameron said the centre will represent Christian through his appeals and may consider a lawsuit over the removals.

Legal challenges will be based on the guarantee of freedom of speech, Cameron suggested.

The centre also represents people charged with violating COVID-19 restrictions, including Saskatoon's Fellowship Baptist Church, which is facing a \$14,000 fine.

Christian complains in the recording that he is being prevented from working, but is told that only his position with the SHA and his academic roles are affected. He can still practise medicine and will receive full compensation during an appeal.

During the meeting, Christian repeats a false claim that gained traction on social media that the World Health Organization changed its advice on vaccines on Monday to oppose injecting COVID-19 vaccines into youth.

Advertisement

STORY CONTINUES BELOW

Article content

The advice actually comes from April 8, and says people under 18 should not be prioritized above other groups that suffer more severe consequences from COVID-19. The WHO has since clarified its advice.

Only the Pfizer vaccine has been approved for use in people as young as 12 in Canada.

Christian appeared with a group in front of Walter Murray Collegiate on June 17 to try to discourage the vaccination of students while a vaccine clinic was happening at the high school.

Christian also mocked the WHO for "peddling nonsense" about the pandemic in a video posted to the website BitChute earlier this month.

In the Wednesday meeting, Christian says he is one of many doctors and scientists who are being silenced and censored for spreading contrary messages about the pandemic.

"You guys are living in a dystopian bubble," Christian says in the meeting. "The truth will come out and when that bubble bursts, you guys are going to be in big trouble."

Shaw expresses concern that Christian's view of the world has changed. She calls him a "highly intelligent man" who is not making intelligent decisions.

Christian is informed that supports are available to him if he is feeling distressed. Christian replies that he's fine. He says he is supported by other doctors in Saskatchewan and Canada.

The U of S and the SHA declined further comment.

Christian did not reply to a request for comment on Thursday.

ptank@postmedia.com

twitter.com/thinktankSK